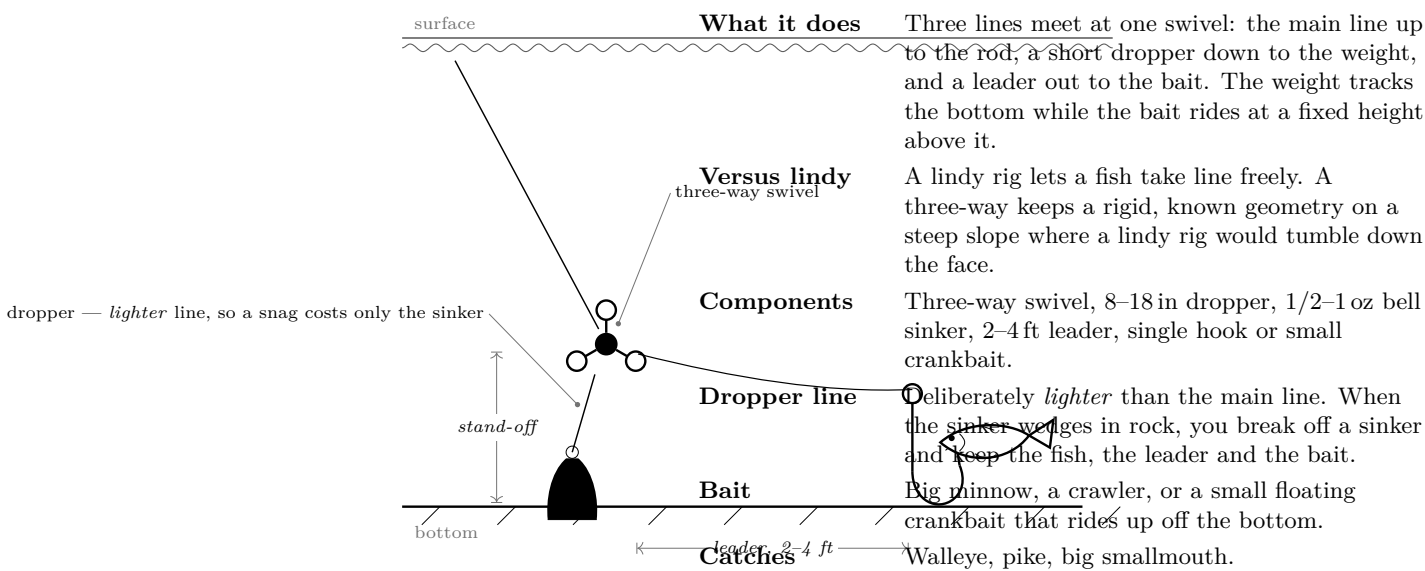


# Three-Way Rig

Also called a wolf river rig

Hold a precise depth on a steep face where nothing else will



## Build it

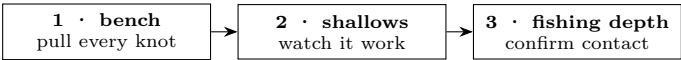
1. Tie the **main line** to the top eye of the three-way swivel.
2. Tie a short **dropper** of lighter line to the bottom eye, and the **sinker** to its end. Make the dropper as long as you want the bait to ride above the bottom.
3. Tie the **leader** to the third eye, then the hook or lure to the leader.

## Fish it

|                              |                                                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Troll or drift slowly</b> | Move at a walking pace with the sinker just ticking bottom. The rig is designed to be moving.                                                                              |
| <b>Vertical line</b>         | Keep the line close to straight down. Let line out until you touch bottom, then take up a few inches. Re-check constantly on a slope — that is the whole point of the rig. |
| <b>Feel for the change</b>   | You are following a contour. When the sinker stops touching, you have moved deep; when it drags hard, you have moved shallow. Steer to keep contact.                       |
| <b>Set</b>                   | A steady sweep. The fish usually hooks itself against the moving boat.                                                                                                     |
| <b>Where</b>                 | Pine spot <b>3</b> — the east wall is the exact situation this rig was invented for — and the steep side of the bar at <b>4</b> . North spot <b>3</b> .                    |

| When to use it                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| On a drop too steep to fish any other way. If you keep losing bottom contact and then plowing, alternately, on a sharp break, this is the rig. It also lets you fish a floating crankbait a fixed 18 inches off the rocks, which is deadly on fall walleye. |

## Prove the rig



|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Bench test</b>     | Pull all three knots separately; measure the 8–18 in dropper and 2–4 ft leader, with the weakest line on the sinker branch.                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Water test</b>     | Tow beside the boat: sinker branch hangs below while the bait leader streams clear without wrapping.                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Proof at depth</b> | The sinker taps continuously enough to map the face while the bait remains above it.                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>If it fails</b>    | Branches twist: shorten the bait leader or lower more slowly. No taps: add weight. Repeated sinker loss is acceptable only if the weak dropper breaks cleanly. Change one variable, repeat the same cast or drop, and keep the first setting that restores the expected proof. |

Record the adjustment

| Try | Depth / distance | Sink count | Observed action | Fish response | Next single change |
|-----|------------------|------------|-----------------|---------------|--------------------|
| 1   |                  |            |                 |               |                    |
| 2   |                  |            |                 |               |                    |
| 3   |                  |            |                 |               |                    |

Questions before another cast

Did the rig reach the intended depth? What visible line, rod-tip, bottom, or lure response proves that? Did the connection and hook point survive the retrieve? Was a follow, bite, snag, or refusal observed rather than assumed? Name one variable to change and one to hold constant. If the observation cannot answer those questions, repeat the same short controlled cast before changing the setup.

☐ Sketch the cast: surface, cover, target depth, line angle, and where the response occurred

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Evidence-based verdict ☐ repeat unchanged ☐ alter one variable ☐ retire or repair the rig

Reason and next prediction

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